



POLICY

Medication: After-Hours Supply

Scope (Staff):	North Metropolitan Health Service Mental Health (NMHS MH) Staff
Scope (Area):	NMHS Mental Health Inpatient Sites

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1. Aim

This document provides North Metropolitan Health Service Mental Health (NMHS MH) clinical staff with the process for obtaining after-hours medication supply for NMHS MH inpatient units.

2. Background

Medication not available on a ward after-hours can be obtained from another ward, if available. There are instances when a medication is not available on-site, there are no therapeutic alternatives available or treatment is required for an inpatient before 0830hrs on the next working day. In these cases medication can be obtained from a local community pharmacy.

3. Pharmacy Department Access

The NMHS MH pharmacy department, based at Graylands Hospital, is not opened after-hours. Only approved pharmacists have access to the pharmacy department after-hours.

4. Risk

Patients may suffer adverse outcomes if medication deemed necessary by medical staff is unable to be obtained outside the hospital pharmacy opening hours or from another unit on site.

Emergency Management	☒	Policy & Legislative Compliance	☒
Governance & Accountability	☒	Quality of Patient Care	☒

5. Definitions

Formulary One: [WA Adult Medicines Formulary](#)

Universal Imprest List: Imprest products listed by location on Graylands Hospital, Frankland & Selby wards.

6. Principles

6.1 Graylands Hospital, Selby Older Adult and Frankland Centre

Obtaining Medications After-Hours

1. The [Universal Imprest List](#) (UIL) is available for consultation on the Mental Health, Public Health and Dental Services Hub under Pharmacy on the intranet. The UIL describes all medications available on impost at Graylands Hospital, Frankland Centre, Selby Lodge and the Graylands Hospital After-Hours Cupboard located on Casson ward.
2. In the event that a medication is not available on the ward outside of normal working hours the medication's nurse will review the UIL. If the medication is available on another ward the medication's nurse will contact that ward and arrange to obtain the medication. If the medication is not listed on the UIL the medications nurse will contact the after-hours nurse manager.
3. The after-hours nurse manager will check the UIL to confirm the medication is not available then contact the duty medical officer who will review the medication chart (and integrated patient progress notes as necessary) to determine whether there is a therapeutic

alternative available and whether the medication is required before 0830hrs on the next working day. The On-Call Pharmacist may be contacted via NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) for clinical advice as part of this decision making process.

4. If there is no therapeutic alternative available and the medication is required before 0830hrs on the next working day the after-hours nurse manager will contact a community pharmacy to ensure that the medication is available. The duty doctor will then write a prescription using WA Health Notifications and Clinical Summaries (NaCS), which may be sent to the local community pharmacy using Transport Services or a taxi courier if Transport is not available. The prescription must be issued for a **whole pack** of the medication and must be issued as a **non-PBS** prescription as it is for inpatient use. See [Appendix 2](#) for list of pharmacies with extended opening hours.
5. The nurse manager will notify the Chief Pharmacist by email when medications are obtained from an outside source. A copy of the prescription will be included in the email.
6. In the case of *urgent* pharmaceuticals not kept by community pharmacies, the nurse manager will contact the NMHS MH On-Call Pharmacist (see [Appendix 1](#)) via the NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) to ensure continued supply of the medication.
7. See [Appendix 3](#) Flow Chart for after-hours supply of medication.

6.2 Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital Mental Health Unit (SCGH MHU) and Mental Health Observation Area (SCGH MHOA)

1. SCGH MHS (SCGH MHU & MHOA) has an agreement with SCGH to supply medications that are not available on the ward after-hours to both services.
2. [Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital Formulary One](#) imprest system lists all medications available on imprest on all wards at the Queen Elizabeth II (QEII) site, Graylands Hospital, Selby Lodge and Frankland Centre.
3. In the event that a medication is not available on the ward outside of normal working hours, the nurse will search Formulary One for the required medication. If the medication is on the imprest of a ward on the QEII site, contact the ward and request for the medication to be sent via the pneumatic tube system with the exception of fragile medications (e.g. medication in glass bottles), cytotoxic medications, S4R and S8 medications. Medications that cannot be sent via the pneumatic tube system will have to be picked up by staff from the ward.
4. If the medication is not available on another ward on the QEII site, the duty medical officer will be contacted and will review the medication chart (and patient notes as necessary) to determine whether there is a therapeutic alternative available and whether the medication is required before 0830hrs on the next working day. The On-Call Pharmacist may be contacted via NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) for clinical advice as part of this decision making process
5. In an event where the medication is only available on a ward outside of the QEII site, e.g. Graylands Hospital, and is deemed necessary before 0830 on the next working day, the



Shift Coordinator or after-hours Clinical Nurse Specialist (CNS) can contact the ward and organise medication to be picked up via a nurse or taxi courier.

6. If the required medication is not available on any wards, the duty medical officer will then generate a prescription via NaCS, which may be sent for dispensing with either a nurse or a taxi courier. The prescription must be issued for a whole pack of the medication and must be issued as a non-PBS prescription as it is for inpatient use.
7. The after-hours CNS will notify the Chief Pharmacist by email when medications obtained from an outside source. A copy of the prescription will be included in the email.
8. In the case of **urgent** pharmaceuticals not kept by community pharmacies, the nurse manager will contact the NMHS MH On-Call Pharmacist via the NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) to ensure continued supply of the medication.

6.3 Osborne Older Adult

1. [SCGHOPHHCG After-hours Procurement of Medicines Guidelines](#)
2. A prescription is required.
3. Refer to the Osborne Park Hospital imprest list on [WA Statewide Formulary](#).
4. In the case of *urgent* pharmaceuticals not kept by community pharmacies, the nurse manager will contact the NMHS MH On-Call Pharmacist via the NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) to ensure continued supply of the medication.

6.4 Mental Health HITH Services

1. A prescription is required and should be produced according to HITH procedures (Best Practice Software)
2. The prescription should be dispensed at the patient's regular community pharmacy if possible, otherwise dispensed at any community pharmacy
3. In the case of *urgent* pharmaceuticals not kept by community pharmacies, the nurse manager will contact the NMHS MH On-Call Pharmacist via the NMHS Telecommunications operator (ph 6159 6600) to ensure continued supply of the medication.

7. Supply of Schedule 4 Restricted (S4R) & Schedule 8 (S8) Medicines

Refer to the inpatient site/s imprest list to search for the available medicine. If not available follow the above processes for obtaining from another source.

Prescriptions written for S8 medicines sent to an after-hours community pharmacy must comply with the [WA Medicines and Poisons Regulations 2016](#) Part 4, Division 1.10.

S4Rs & S8s transferred from other wards or obtained from a community pharmacy must be entered into the appropriate register.



Refer also to the [NMHS MH Medication: Prescribing and Supply of Stimulants](#); [WA Medicines Handling Policy MP 0139/20](#).

8. Management of Opioid Pharmacotherapy

For a patient admitted, currently treated under the Community Program for Opioid Pharmacotherapy (CPOP), treatment can be continued.

This includes:

- A prescriber is authorised to treat the person.
- The person has received their doses in accordance with their prescription.
- The person has a current opioid substitution therapy (OST) prescription.

If it can not be determined that the patient is currently treating, OST doses must not be prescribed or administered.

[WA Guideline on continuation of opioid substitution treatment in hospitals](#).

9. Supply of Medications to Another Ward After-Hours

1. Wards in Graylands Hospital and the after-hours cupboard on Casson will supply medications to other wards at Graylands Hospital, Selby Lodge, Frankland Centre, Osborne Lodge, MHOA and SCGH MHU after-hours.
2. The CNS must notify ward clinical pharmacist the next business day.

10. Compliance and Evaluation

Staff will obtain medications in accordance with this policy.

- Compliance with this policy will be audited annually by the NMHS MH pharmacy department.
- Datix CIMS incidences recorded for doses not administered as a result of medication not being available.
- Record of after hours scripts – recurring items, inappropriate ordering of items available will be maintained by NMHS MH pharmacy department.

Related internal policies, procedures and guidelines

[Graylands Hospital, Selby Lodge, Frankland Centre Universal Imprest](#)

[Sir Charles Gairdner Hospital Formulary One](#)

[Osborne Park Hospital Nursing and Midwifery Guidelines – After-Hours Procurement of Medicines](#)

[Universal Imprest List](#)

References

[National Safety & Quality Health Service Standards Ed 2 2017](#)

[WA Medicines and Poisons Regulations 2016](#)

[WA Medicines Handling Policy MP 0139/20](#)

[WA Guideline on continuation of opioid substitution treatment in hospitals](#)

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	V1	GHMT Corporate	Endorsed
Updates 1992-2017	V2		Graylands Hospital Policy Clin 57
Dec 2021	V3	NMHS MH A/Chief Pharmacist	Previously Graylands policy, rescinded. Created NMHS MH policy; new template; update details & hyperlinks
26/2/2025	V3.1	Chief Pharmacist, NMHS MH	Reviewed. Added information regarding pharmacy access after hours. Updated reference for Osborne Lodge after hours.

The health impact upon Aboriginal people have been considered, and where relevant incorporated and appropriately addressed in the development of this health initiative ISD#4081

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Appendix 1. On-Call Pharmacist Service

NMHS MH Pharmacy provides an on-call service to all NMHS MH sites after-hours.

On-call pharmacist can be contacted via NMHS Telecommunications operator on: (08) 6159 6600.

On-call hours:

Days	On-Call hours
Monday - Friday	16:30 - 08:30
Saturday, Sunday and Public Holidays	00:00 - 23:59

Appendix 2. Community Pharmacies

The following is a list of pharmacies close to Graylands Hospital which have extended opening hours. This list is not prescriptive and other pharmacies may be used; also refer to the [‘Pharmacies with a current MOU listed by suburb’](#).

Mosman Drive-In Chemist

590 Stirling Highway

Mosman Park

Tel: 9384 0219

Opening hours: Monday to Sunday 8am-8pm

EXCEPT: Public holidays 9am- 5pm; Christmas Day: Closed

Stirling Drive-In Pharmacy 777

234 Stirling Highway

Claremont

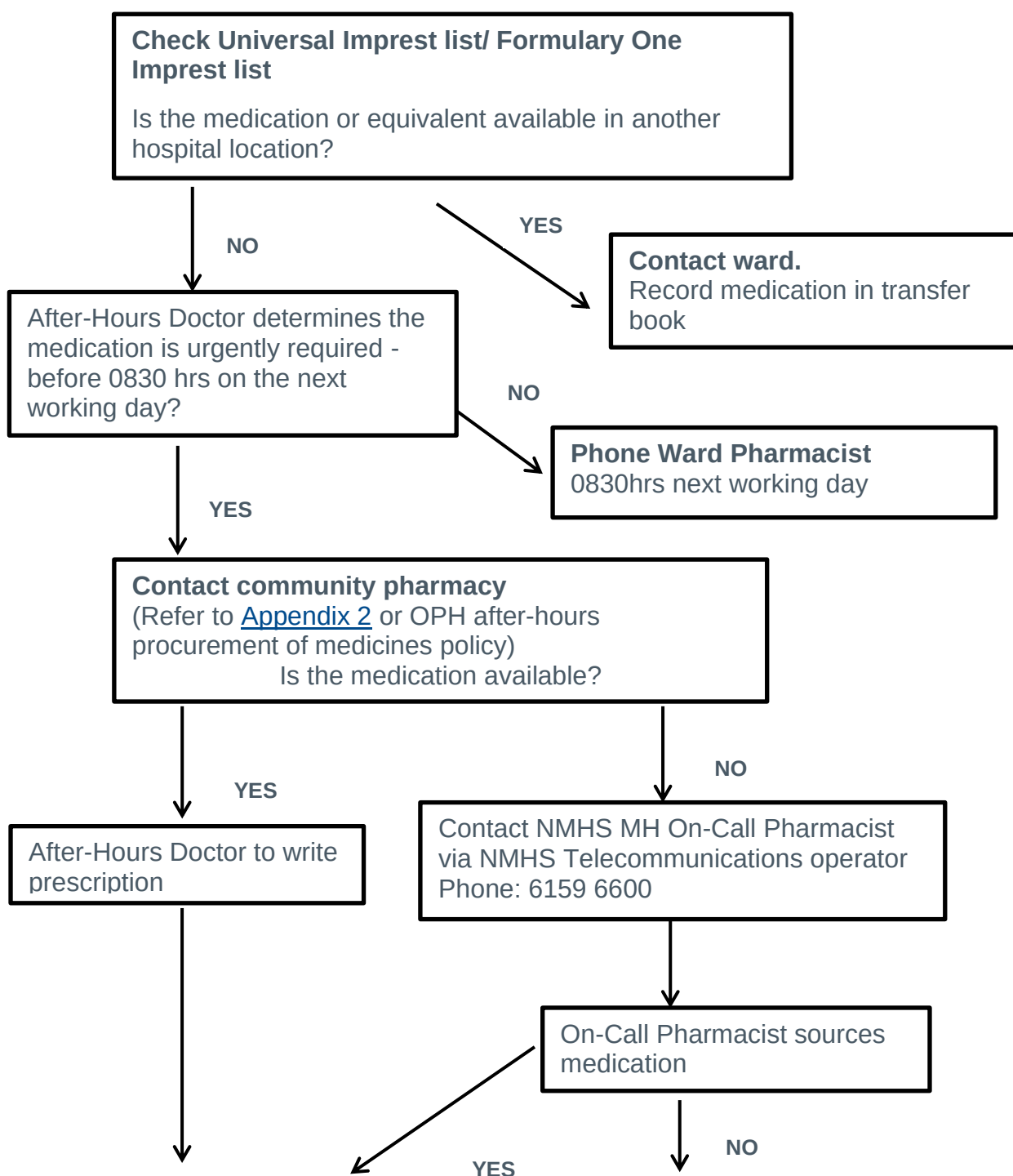
Tel: 9384 2292

Opening hours: 7am –11pm 365 days of the year

Beaufort Street Pharmacy

647 Beaufort St

Appendix 3. Flow Chart for after-hours supply of medication at NMHS MH sites



Send Courier / taxi to collect

On-Call Pharmacist contacts
the After-Hours Dr to discuss



Complete incident report. Send copies to Finance
officer and Chief Pharmacist